

OBJECTIVES

To create a character objective using correct objective phrasing.

DESCRIPTION

A character's objective is what a character wants. It is based in what they want from another person, using the formula "I want [person] to do [thing I want them to do]." The objective is what drives all of their action while onstage. Actors will learn what objectives are and how to write one for a character.

MATERIALS

Either scenes that students have already been assigned or a short scene for them to analyze.

INSTRUCTION

1. Introduction:

As an introduction/warmup, start by telling the class to think of something they want from two different people in the class. It can be anything (shoes, sunglasses, homework, friendship), as long as it is school appropriate. They are to think of two different things that they want from two different people. Give them a few minutes to consider what they want. Once everyone has thought of two different things, tell them to go talk to their classmates and get what they want. Give students several minutes to try to get what they want from each other.

2. Discussion:

Have students return to their seats. Ask for the students who got at least one thing they wanted to raise their hands. Call on students with their hand raised and ask what they got and from whom. Once several people have explained what they want, give students a minute or two to return any objects to their rightful owners.

3. What is an Objective?:

Just like you had things you wanted, any character you play also has things they want.

WHAT A CHARACTER WANTS IS CALLED THE "OBJECTIVE."

-You try to get your objective any time onstage Just like in this exercise, objectives are always what the character wants from someone else. It is not enough to say "I want shoes" or "I want love." You have to include who you want things from. So, instead of "I want shoes," it is "I want my mom to buy me shoes." Instead of "I want love," it's "I want my friend to fall in love with me."

THERE IS A FORMULA ALL OBJECTIVES SHOULD FOLLOW:

- "I want [person] to do [thing I want them to do]."

You play your objective, or try to get what you want, until you get it or until the scene ends. And if you get your objective, you start fighting for a new one. You won't always get your objective, but you fight for it all the same.

4. Why?

So that there is connection onstage between actors. Trying to get something from someone else pushes you to connect with the other actors onstage. It makes characters and relationships look more real and more engaging.

5. Modeling:

Give several examples of objectives and have students identify whether or not they are phrased correctly or incorrectly.

*Objectives must go through the other person.

- I want food (incorrect)
- I want my boyfriend to make me dinner (correct)
- I want peace and quiet (incorrect)
- I want my class to stop talking (correct)
- I want something to do (incorrect)
- I want my friends to go out with me (correct)
- I want sunglasses (incorrect)
- I want my friend to lend me her sunglasses (correct)
- I want an A (incorrect)
- I want my teacher to change my grade to an A (correct)

6. How Do You Know What the Objective Is?

*Read the play.

Identify:

What the character seem to want?

What is their objective. * There is rarely one correct objective.

-Discuss character objectives to popular media:

- Star Wars
- Lord of the Rings
- Harry Potter

Romeo and Juliet. Romeo's objective could be "I want Juliet to fall in love with me" or "I want Juliet to marry me." Juliet's could be "I want Romeo to prove he loves me" or "I want my parents to give me more control over my life."

7. **Assignment:**

Get out current scene scripts.

-Write down your character's objective - following correct phrasing.

ASSIGNMENT CHECKLIST

Hand in character objective at the end of class.

- Did you identify the character's objective?
- Did you phrase it using the formula "I want [person] to do [thing I want them to do]?"

ASSESSMENT

The assessment will grade the objectives students turn in. If students find the objective and phrase it correctly, they will succeed on the assessment.

NATIONAL CORE ARTS STANDARDS

TH:Cr1.1: GENERATE AND CONCEPTUALIZE ARTISTIC IDEAS AND WORK - HIGH SCHOOL PROFICIENT

TH:Cr1.1.HSI.c - Use script analysis to generate ideas about a character that is believable and authentic in a drama/theatre work.

TH:Cr2.1: ORGANIZE AND DEVELOP ARTISTIC IDEAS AND WORK - GRADE HS ACCOMPLISHED

TH:Cr2.1.HSII.b - Cooperate as a creative team to make interpretive choices for a drama/theatre work.

TH:Cr2.1: ORGANIZE AND DEVELOP ARTISTIC IDEAS AND WORK - GRADE HS ADVANCED

TH:Cr2.1.HSIII.b - Collaborate as a creative team to discover artistic solutions and make interpretive choices in a devised or scripted drama/theatre work.

TH:Cr3.1: REFINE NEW WORK THROUGH PLAY, DRAMA PROCESSES AND THEATRE EXPERIENCES USING CRITICAL ANALYSIS AND EXPERIMENTATION - GRADE HS ADVANCED

TH:Cr3.1.HSIII.a - Refine, transform, and re-imagine a devised or scripted drama/theatre work using the rehearsal process to invent or re-imagine style, genre, form, and conventions.

TH:Pr4.1: SELECT, ANALYZE, AND INTERPRET ARTISTIC WORK FOR PRESENTATION - GRADE HS PROFICIENT

TH:Pr4.1.HSI.a - Examine how character relationships assist in telling the story of a drama/theatre work.

TH:Pr4.1.HSI.b - Shape character choices using given circumstances in a drama/theatre work.



